XAU / GOLD · Q3 2026 IN BRIEF

Central banks bought more. Gold prices still fell.

Central-bank demand can support gold, while your return still depends on the market price, currency movements and costs.

Three things to know

Official buying increased. The World Gold Council estimated 321.2 tonnes of net buying in Q3 2026. Net buying means purchases less sales by central banks and other official institutions. [1]

Some buyers remain unidentified. Public disclosures accounted for 120 tonnes within that total estimate. The estimates can be revised as more information arrives. [1]

Your spending currency matters. For a holding without currency protection, gold's USD price and the USD-to-SGD exchange rate both affect your SGD return. A stronger SGD can reduce or even erase a USD gold gain.

The same quarter, two different directions

Q3 versus Q2 2026 · percentage changes as published

Measure	Change
Official gold demand [1]	+8%
Gold price, World Bank review [2]	-5%

Report interpretation · **Other investors also influence the price.** Their selling and changes in market conditions can outweigh official buying. This comparison alone cannot show what caused the price move.

Risks and your next step

Gold can fall alongside other investments. Higher bond returns after inflation and a stronger US dollar can pressure gold prices. Physical gold pays no coupon, and dealing, fund or storage costs reduce returns. [3]

Decide the purpose before buying. Consider how long you can hold gold, cash you may need in SGD, and the product's costs and how it handles currency risk.

Data date · Research cutoff 6 November 2026, 16:40 SGT. Q3 data cover July-September 2026.

Key sources · [1] WGC Q3 data / central banks (3 Nov 2026). [2] World Bank outlook (Oct 2026). [3] IMF gold-reserves paper (9 Jul 2026).

Read the full report - Edition 2

Edition 2 summary prepared 14 November 2026.